

found, but Barton's office succeeded in locating hundreds of soldiers' remains, their graves, and, occasionally, a live soldier. This information comforted countless loved ones in the North who yearned for news that could confirm the fate of a husband, brother, or son who had not returned. Under the auspices of her new position, Barton was instrumental in identifying nearly 13,000 dead Union prisoners of war at Andersonville, Georgia, and placing headstones over their graves.



Andersonville graves

Barton was involved in the monumental task of tracing all the men who had gone missing in the war. Many had died—of malnutrition and disease—in the hellish prison camp at Andersonville, Georgia, where she played a major part in organizing their grave markers.

American Red Cross

In 1870, at the outbreak of the Franco-Prussian War, Barton was in Europe and offered her assistance to the sick and wounded of both sides. Working mainly in Strasbourg and Paris, she learned much about the International Red Cross and became an enthusiastic supporter of the organization. Returning home, she led a crusade to found an American branch of the society, meeting strong institutional and governmental resistance. Finally, in 1881, Barton's